

Forest Improvement Project

November 2026

The Harmony USD Redwood Forest will be getting some TLC this fall!

A Partnership

The Gold Ridge RCD has partnered with Harmony USD and four private neighbors to design and fund a forest improvement project. Foresters at Environmental Resource Solutions, Inc. are bringing in a talented tree crew to thin out unhealthy trees and shrubs, reveal beautiful healthy redwoods, balance the fuel load, and spur new growth in a vibrant understory.





A Safer Forest

The project will improve access to trails, views of the canyon, and the school's safety in a future wildfire.

Tanoaks distressed by sudden oak death, fir seedlings that crowd the forest floor, and unhealthy bays will come down and open space for redwoods, madrones, maples, hazelnut, Oregon White Oak and other midstory and understory trees.

You’ll Hear the Hum

In November, students will hear the sounds of the forestry crew running chain saws and working hard to pile the forest debris into piles that will be burned next spring.





Wildlife Abounds

With more growing space opened in the understory, students and hikers may notice more new growth on the forest floor over winter and into next spring!

New growth provides forage for wildlife, such as rodents, songbirds, deer and pollinators. These in turn feed predatory animals such as insects, arachnids, reptiles, foxes, hawks and owls.

Let It Flow

The project will reduce the number of small trees in the forest so that the forest can put its energy and resources towards growing the big trees.

Fewer, bigger trees also means more available groundwater, more available nutrients, and more available moisture in the environment for everything else to grow.





Vision for the Future

Harmony USD and its neighbors share a vision for a redwood forest that is resilient to wildfire, grows the next generation of old growth redwoods, provides habitat for abundant wildlife, has clear and ample water, and inspires its visitors to connect with the natural world.

This project is made possible by Harmony USD, four neighbors, Gold Ridge RCD, CAL FIRE's North Bay Forest Improvement Program and the County of Sonoma's Vegetation Management Grant Program.

